Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report

Residential Care

Licensee: JBARJ Youth Services - J5/ The Ranch
Executive Director: Stephanie Alvstad
Board Chairperson: Jeanette McKenzie
Date of Unannounced: June 12, 2023 and June 13th, 2023
Licensing Coordinator: Ed Wyller
Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: Oregon Youth Authority (OYA) and Council of Accreditation (COA)

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings Unannounced Site Visit 11/01/2022 – 11/02/2022	**Repeat Findings Further Action Needed**	**Comments**
Consents 413-215-0576(1) (e) Allow access as defined in 413-215-0091 & 0101 J5 and Ranch missing consents to allow access as defined in 413-215-0091 & 0101. Repeated Finding: Both J5 and The Ranch youth charts were missing the consents to allow access as defined in 413-215-0091 and 0101.	**Yes☐ No✓**	• I verified that youth charts now have consents to allow access as defined in 413-215-0091 and 0101 at J5 and The Ranch. (In Compliance)
Additional Findings Related to SB 710:	**Yes☐ No✓**	• I verified that the developed SB 710 forms are being used in the youth charts at both J5 and The Ranch. (In Compliance)

413-215-0077 (11)(e): Each child agency shall provide notice regarding how to access the quarterly reports to the parents or guardians of children in care in the program. The child caring agency shall provide the notice upon the child in care's admission and at least two times each year thereafter. Repeated Finding: J5 and The Ranch youth files did not have documentation indicating that the information required by 413-215-0077 (11) (e) was provided at the time of admissions. JBARJ Agency has developed the required forms however they have not been implemented in the residential programs.		
Additional Findings Related to SB 710: 413-215-0078 (1) Each child in care receiving services from a child caring agency must be given the following: (a) Instruction regarding how a child in care may report suspected inappropriate use of restraint or seclusion. (b) Assurance that the child in care will not experience retaliation for reporting suspected inappropriate uses of restraint or involuntary seclusion. (c) The telephone number for the toll-free child abuse hotline described in ORS 417.805 and the telephone numbers and electronic mail addresses for the program's licensing agency, the child in care's caseworker, and attorney, the child in care's court appointed special advocate and Disability Rights Oregon. Repeated Finding: J5 and The Ranch youth files did not have documentation of the information described in by 413-215-0078 (1)	**Yes☐ No✓**	• I verified that the developed SB 710 forms are being used in the youth charts at both J5 and The Ranch. (In Compliance)

having been provided to children in care. JBARJ Agency has developed the required forms however they have not been implemented in the residential programs. Note I observed the OYA letter "Youth Safety Guide" posted in J5 for youth to read regarding their rights.		

New Findings from Site Visit	Comments
N/A	No new findings, Great work!

Interview Summary
J5: I interviewed two youth separately in the empty pod adjacent to the classroom. Youth reported feeling safe at J5. On a scale from 0-10 (0=worst program and 10=best program) youth reported J5 to be an 8 and an 8.5 on that scale. One youth reported, "feels supported" in reference to J5 staff. The other youth reported "gets along with everyone, and staff are all good." Food was described as good, and youth reported having snacks. Youth reported that program has cakes for youth birthdays and pizza for program graduation for all. Youth reported that allergies to food are addressed, such as onions and lactose allergies. For fun, youth reported playing video games, cards, reading, basketball, football, and working out. Youth reported going on outings on Fridays to Dairy Queen. Youth also reported that case managers can take youth to Dutch Bros. Youth reported going to skills group daily except no groups on Saturday. Youth reported leaning skills such as how to resolve conflict and how to forgive people. Youth reported having phone calls with family and both on and off-site visits. One youth is hoping to soon to attain 2T level, which means a bigger bedroom, bigger mattress and a 2T basket that is filled weekly with snacks such as: soda, chips, cookies, skittles, and other candies. When asked if given a magic wand to improve program, one youth reported not having the program in housed a detention facility building, and the other youth reported more outings would be preferable. I spoke with staff, teacher, and management. J5 has one of two pods currently opened at this time. J5 receives referrals from the Oregon Youth Authority and has a wait list. A current barrier is not having enough trained staff to reopen the other pod that can hold up to 12 youth. Staff reported being happy with the program and the work they do with youth. **The Ranch:** I interviewed two youth independently by the outdoor full size basketball court (picnic tables). On a scale from 0-10 (0=worst program and 10=best program) one youth reported The Ranch to be a 5 and the other youth reported it to be a 7. When asked about those scores, the youth that stated a 7 reported no program is a 10. "10 is home". The other youth reported a 5 and stated, "its not bad and it's not good". Youth reported feeling safe. School was reported to be good. One youth reported that they have earned 13 high school credits and enjoys the Ingenuity school program. When asked what they have learned at The Ranch, one youth reported they learned how to control their anger and the other youth reported they learned to "be a responsible person". Food was reported to be good. Youth reported enjoying playing basketball on site. Both enjoy the on-site recreation/weight room. Youth reported outings to include mini-golf, hiking, walking, parks, movies, bike rides, and scenic drives. When asked if given a magic wand what would you change about The Ranch to improve the program, one youth reported thy would make The Ranch less strict. The other youth would like to spend more time outside on the weekends.

Staff reported that they are fully staffed and receiving training. It was reported the vocational program continues to be a success, and the staff are gearing up for the annual Horse Show. Many youths will be hired and will earn money for preparing for this event. Management reports staffing seems to have stabilized.

Observations

J5: Has purchased new mattresses. Program has purchased a full-size arcade to have on each pod. J5 has purchased new washers. I observed that the new sod had survived the winter and is looking good. Youth now have an outdoor field to play football and soccer on. J5 management showed me their newly added tracking of youth skills. J5 utilizes ChangeCompanies curriculum and is using the computerized pre and post testing regarding skills attained while in program. This has been helpful in assessing and marking progress for each youth. Program reports JPPO's have been pleased about having this information during case reviews.

I observed the youth in school during my visit in the classroom between the two pods. Interactions between J5 staff and youth was supportive and encouraging. I found J5 to be clean and orderly. It was reported this Friday the youth were going off site for haircuts.

The Ranch: I observed most of the youth involved in the on-site school (vocational building and the on-site classrooms). A few youths were helping clean up in the Kitchen. I found The Ranch to be clean and organized. I observed maintenance workers working on facility fencing and irrigation systems for the fields. The Ranch has built new personal holding shelves in the dorm. Youth built these in their vocational program.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes:

All previous findings have been corrected and no new findings identified. Good work!

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: _____ Date: 7/05/2023

Manager Review: _____ Date: 6-28-2023